

READ

1. Passage anchor

> “If the whole class looked confused, she could **read the room** instantly and change her approach on the spot.”

Passage meaning

read the room = quickly understand the mood, reactions, or social atmosphere of a group

看懂現場氣氛；察言觀色；判斷大家的反應

Here, Ms. Lau can tell from students' expressions and behavior that they are confused, then adjust her teaching.

Practice

1. Good teachers know how to **read the room**.

好老師懂得**看懂現場氣氛**。

2. She could **read the room** and tell when students needed another explanation.

她能**察覺全班的反應**，知道學生甚麼時候需要另一種解釋。

Core meanings of READ

2. read — understand written words

= look at written or printed words and understand their meaning

閱讀；讀

Examples

1. I **read the article** last night.

我昨晚**讀了那篇文章**。

2. She likes to **read books** about science.

她喜歡**閱讀科學書籍**。

This is the central literal meaning.

3. read something aloud

= speak written words so others can hear them

****朗讀；念出****

Examples

1. Please ****read the sentence aloud****.

請把這個句子****朗讀出來****。

2. She ****read the instructions aloud**** to the class.

她把說明****念給全班聽****。

Read as study / inspect text carefully

4. read — study written material

= examine written material carefully to learn or understand it

****研讀；閱讀研究****

Examples

1. I need to ****read the chapter carefully****.

我需要仔細****研讀這一章****。

2. She ****read several research papers**** before the meeting.

她在會議前****讀了幾篇研究論文****。

Interpret signs / information

5. read — interpret information shown by a device, chart, or sign

= understand the information indicated or displayed

****讀取；判讀****

Examples

1. Can you ****read this graph****?

你看得懂這張圖表嗎？

2. The technician ****read the meter****.

技術人員****讀取了儀表數值****。

6. read a map

= understand and use a map

看懂地圖；判讀地圖

Examples

1. She knows how to **read a map**.

她知道怎麼**看地圖**。

2. I'm terrible at **reading maps**.

我很不會**判讀地圖**。

Interpret people / situations

7. read someone

= understand someone's feelings, intentions, or character from their behavior

看懂某人；判斷某人的心思

Examples

1. She is very good at **reading people**.

她很會**看人 / 判斷別人的心思**。

2. I couldn't **read his expression**.

我看不懂他的表情。

8. read the room

= understand the mood and reactions of a group

看懂現場氣氛；察言觀色

This is the exact passage expression.

Examples

1. He failed to **read the room** and kept joking.

他沒有**看懂現場氣氛**，還一直開玩笑。

2. She quickly **read the room** and changed the topic.

她很快**察覺現場氣氛**並換了話題。

9. read someone's face / expression

= interpret what someone is feeling from facial cues

從表情看出；解讀表情

Examples

1. I could **read the disappointment on her face**.

我可以從她臉上**看出失望**。

2. He tried to **read her expression**.

他試著**解讀她的表情**。

Understand meaning / implication

10. read something as...

= interpret something in a particular way

把.....理解為；解讀為

Examples

1. I **read his silence as disagreement**.

我把他的沉默**理解為不同意**。

2. Her comment could be **read as criticism**.

她的評論可能會被**解讀為批評**。

Very useful figurative sense.

11. read between the lines

= understand a hidden or implied meaning

讀出言外之意；看懂弦外之音

Examples

1. You need to **read between the lines**.

你需要**看懂話裡真正的意思**。

2. If you **read between the lines**, she is clearly worried.

如果你**看出弦外之音**，就會知道她其實很擔心。

Indicate / display

12. read — show a particular measurement or message

= indicate a particular number, value, or wording

顯示；讀數為

Examples

1. The thermometer **reads 25°C**.

溫度計**顯示攝氏25度**。

2. The sign **reads “No Entry.”**

標誌上**寫著「禁止進入」**。

Text wording

13. read — be written in a particular way

= have particular words written or printed

寫著；內容為

Examples

1. The notice **reads as follows**.

公告內容**如下**。

2. The final line **reads differently** in the revised version.

修訂版最後一行的**文字不同**。

Proofreading / reviewing

14. read — check written work

= examine writing carefully, often for errors or quality

****審閱；校讀****

Examples

1. Could you ****read my essay**** before I submit it?

你可以在我交作業前幫我****看一下作文****嗎？

2. The editor ****read the manuscript**** carefully.

編輯仔細****審閱了稿件****。

Academic specialization

15. read a subject — BrE, especially university context

= study a subject formally, especially at university

****攻讀某科****

Examples

1. She ****read physics at university****.

她在大學****攻讀物理****。

2. He ****read law at Oxford****.

他在牛津****攻讀法律****。

This is mainly British and formal.

Computing / data

16. read data

= access or retrieve information from storage or a device

****讀取資料****

Examples

1. The program can ****read data from the file****.

程式可以從檔案中****讀取資料****。

2. The sensor ****reads the signal**** continuously.

感測器會持續****讀取訊號****。

17. read-only

= able to be viewed or accessed but not changed

****唯讀的****

Examples

1. The file is ****read-only****.

這個檔案是****唯讀的****。

2. Users have ****read-only access****.

使用者只有****唯讀權限****。

Related noun forms

18. a read

= an act or experience of reading something

****閱讀；讀物****

Examples

1. It's a fascinating ****read****.

這是一本 / 一篇很吸引人的****讀物****。

2. The article is a quick ****read****.

這篇文章****很快就能讀完****。

Informal but common.

19. reader

= person who reads; also a device/program that reads information

****讀者；閱讀器****

Examples

1. The book is aimed at younger ****readers****.

這本書是寫給年輕****讀者****看的。

2. The card **reader** is not working.

讀卡**機**壞了。

20. reading

A. activity of reading

閱讀

B. interpretation

解讀

C. measurement shown by an instrument

讀數

Examples

1. Regular **reading** improves vocabulary.

規律**閱讀**能提升詞彙量。

2. Her **reading** of the situation was accurate.

她對情況的**解讀**很準確。

3. The temperature **reading** was unusually high.

溫度**讀數**異常偏高。

High-value expressions

21. read up on something

= study a subject by reading about it

查閱資料；研讀

Examples

1. I need to **read up on** quantum physics.

我需要**查資料**了解量子物理。

2. She **read up on** the topic before the interview.

她面試前先**查閱了**相關資料。

22. read over / through

= read something carefully from beginning to end or review it

****仔細閱讀；通讀****

Examples

1. Please ****read over your answer**** before submitting it.

提交前請****檢查 / 重讀你的答案****。

2. I ****read through the report**** twice.

我把報告****完整讀了兩遍****。

23. read into something

= find or assume more meaning in something than may actually be there

****過度解讀；從.....推想太多****

Examples

1. Don't ****read too much into his comment****.

不要對他的評論****過度解讀****。

2. She may be ****reading something into the silence**** that isn't there.

她可能對那份沉默****想得太多****。

Pronunciation / form note

24. read has identical spelling but different pronunciation

Present/base:

> ****read****

> "I read every day."

Past/past participle:

> ****read****

> "I read it yesterday."

The spelling does not change, but the pronunciation does.

This is a high-value learner distinction.

Key contrasts

25. read vs study

****read****

= process written text

****閱讀****

****study****

= deliberately work to understand and learn, often using reading plus other methods

****學習 ; 研讀****

Compare:

> I ****read the chapter****.

> 我讀了那一章。

> I ****studied the chapter**** for the exam.

> 我為考試仔細研讀那一章。

26. read vs interpret

****read****

can figuratively mean interpret.

****interpret****

= explain or understand the meaning of something, often more formally

****解讀 ; 詮釋****

Compare:

> She ****read his expression**** correctly.

> 她正確看懂了他的表情。

> Experts ****interpreted the results**** differently.

> 專家對結果有不同解讀。

27. read vs understand

****understand****

= broad comprehension

****read****

in figurative contexts often means infer meaning from signs, behavior, mood, or evidence.

Compare:

> I understand the theory.

> 我理解理論。

> I can ****read the mood of the class****.

> 我能看懂班級氣氛。

28. read the room vs read someone

****read the room****

= assess the mood of a group or setting

****read someone****

= assess one person's feelings, motives, or character

The passage specifically uses the group/social-atmosphere sense.

Meaning map

The central concept of ****read**** is:

****extract meaning from signs****

From this develop:

Written text

read a book

→ ****閱讀****

Spoken text

read aloud

→ **朗讀**

Visual information

read a map / graph

→ **判讀**

People

read someone

→ **看懂 / 判斷**

Social atmosphere

read the room

→ **察言觀色**

Hidden meaning

read between the lines

→ **看出言外之意**

Interpretation

read something as...

→ **解讀為**

Instrument

the meter reads 50

→ **顯示**

Computing

read data

→ **讀取資料**

The passage uses the social-interpretation branch:

observe the students' faces and behavior

→ **infer their shared emotional/mental state**

→ **read the room**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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read — written text	看文字並理解其意思；閱讀
read aloud	把文字念出來讓別人聽；朗讀
read — study text carefully	仔細閱讀、研讀資料以理解內容
read a graph/map/meter	判讀圖表、地圖、儀器所提供的資訊
read someone	從行為、表情等判斷某人的感受、意圖或性格
read the room	從群體反應判斷現場氣氛、情緒或大家的態度
read someone's expression	從某人的臉部表情推斷其感受
read something as...	把某個行為、訊息或現象理解 / 解讀為.....
read between the lines	理解沒有直接說出的隱含意思
read — instrument displays	儀器顯示某個數值
read — wording says	標誌、文件等寫著某些文字
read — proof/check writing	仔細查看書面內容以評估或找出問題
read a subject — BrE	在大學正式攻讀某科目
read data	從檔案、感測器或系統中讀取資訊
read-only	可以查看但不能修改的；唯讀的
a read	一次閱讀經驗；也可指某篇 / 某本讀物
reader	閱讀文字的人；也可指讀取資料的裝置
reading — activity	閱讀這項活動
reading — interpretation	對某情況、作品或證據的理解 / 解讀
reading — measurement	儀器顯示的數值；讀數
read up on	透過閱讀資料來深入了解某個主題
read over/through	仔細重讀 / 從頭到尾讀一遍
read into	從某件事推想過多隱含意思；過度解讀

Passage recap

> “If the whole class looked confused, she could **read the room** instantly...”

Here:

read the room = **understand the mood, reactions, and shared state of a group from social cues**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **看懂現場氣氛**

* **察言觀色**

* **看出全班的反應**

* **判斷大家當下的狀態**

Natural contextual translation:

****如果全班看起來一頭霧水，她幾乎可以立刻察覺大家的反應。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****read the room****

= ****judge the mood and reactions of the people present and adjust accordingly****

****看懂現場氣氛；察言觀色；判斷眾人的反應****

The metaphor is:

> ****read written words****

> → extract meaning from visible signs

then:

> ****read the room****

> → extract social meaning from people's expressions, behavior, and atmosphere.